DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 5

Business analyst

Profession 5 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A business analyst defines what a business needs from a system or change: requirements, processes, data needs and acceptance tests.

What professionals do every day

Interviews stakeholders, maps current processes, writes requirements, checks feasibility with the team and tests the delivered solution.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Projects fail when requirements are unclear. A business analyst makes them clear before money is spent.

- Vague requests that become rework.
- Processes nobody has written down.
- Tests that do not match the need.

Skills you need

- Requirements writing (user stories, acceptance criteria).
- Process mapping.
- Stakeholder interviews.
- Basic data analysis to size the problem.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Miro	Process maps	Free tier	Paid plans	miro.com
Jira	Requirements tracking (see Development and IT)	Free tier	Paid plans	www.atlassian.com/software/jira
Excel	Sizing and comparisons	Free online version	Microsoft 365 plans	www.microsoft.com/microsoft-365/excel

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Write five user stories with acceptance criteria.
Intermediate	Map the current process for one task.
Advanced	Write a requirements document for a small change.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Booking process for a clinic.
- **Intermediate:** Invoice approval for a firm.
- **Advanced:** Enquiry handling for a training company.

Client-ready portfolio project

A requirements pack for a fictional clinic's enquiry process: stakeholders, current and future process maps, five user stories with acceptance criteria.

Worked example

Worked example. 'As a receptionist, I see new enquiries in one list, so I reply within an hour.' The acceptance test: a new enquiry appears in the list within a minute.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

User stories with acceptance criteria

Business problem: A clinic wants a faster enquiry reply.

Steps

1. List the people involved in the enquiry process.
2. Write five user stories in the 'As a..., I want..., so that...' form.
3. Add acceptance criteria to each story.
4. Check each story is testable.

Expected output: Five stories with testable criteria.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

Each story names a person and a benefit. Each acceptance criterion can be checked yes or no, which is what makes the story testable.

Common mistakes

- Requirements that say 'fast' or 'easy' without a measure.
- Skipping stakeholders who will use the result.
- Changing requirements without a record.
- Writing solutions instead of needs.

Freelancing opportunities

- Requirements and process projects for small firms.
- Analysis for system implementations.
- Briefs for 'business analyst', 'requirements document', 'process mapping'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- IIBA: business analysis body of knowledge (check current resources)

Part of **Master Freelancing: Data Analytics and Data Science**. Back to the chapter list on skillnavora.in · Open the full textbook. Official links in this chapter were not checked live; confirm before relying on them.